Pearson

Mark Scheme (Results)

Summer 2026

Pearson Edexcel GCSE

In History (1HI0)

Paper 1: Thematic study and historic environment (1HI0/11)

Option 11: Medicine in Britain, c1250–present and The British sector of the Western Front, 1914–18: injuries, treatment and the trenches

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

How to award marks when level descriptions are used

1. Finding the right level

The first stage is to decide which level the answer should be placed in. To do this, use a 'best-fit' approach, deciding which level most closely describes the quality of the answer. Answers can display characteristics from more than one level, and where this happens markers must use the guidance below and their professional judgement to decide which level is most appropriate. For example, one stronger passage at L4 would not by itself merit a L4 mark, but it might be evidence to support a high L3 mark, unless there are substantial weaknesses in other areas. Similarly, an answer that fits best in L3 but which has some characteristics of L2 might be placed at the bottom of L3. An answer displaying some characteristics of L3 and some of L1 might be placed in L2.

2. Finding a mark within a level

After a level has been decided on, the next stage is to decide on the mark within the level. The instructions below tell you how to reward responses within a level. However, where a level has specific guidance about how to place an answer within a level, always follow that guidance.

Levels containing two marks only

Start with the presumption that the work will be at the top of the level. Move down to the lower mark if the work only just meets the requirements of the level.

Levels containing three or more marks

Markers should be prepared to use the full range of marks available in a level and not restrict marks to the middle. Markers should start at the middle of the level (or the upper-middle mark if there is an even number of marks) and then move the mark up or down to find the best mark. To do this, they should take into account how far the answer meets the requirements of the level:

- If it meets the requirements *fully*, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for answers that are as good as can realistically be expected within that level.
- If it only *barely* meets the requirements of the level, markers should consider awarding marks at the bottom of the level. The bottom mark in the level is used for answers that are the weakest that can be expected within that level.
- The middle marks of the level are used for answers that have a *reasonable* match to the descriptor. This might represent a balance between some characteristics of the level that are fully met and others that are only barely met.

Indicative content

Examiners are reminded that indicative content is provided as an illustration to markers of some of the material that may be offered by students. It does not show required content and alternatives should be credited where valid.

The British sector of the Western Front, 1914–18: injuries, treatment and the trenches

Question	
1 (a)	Describe **one** feature of a Casualty Clearing Station (CCS). **Target**: knowledge of key features and characteristics of the period. **AO1**: 2 marks.

Marking instructions

Award 1 mark for a valid feature identified. The second mark should be awarded for supporting information.

e.g.

- *A Casualty Clearing Station was a well-equipped medical facility* ***(1)****, with access to mobile x-ray machines and beds for injured men* ***(1)****.*
- *A Casualty Clearing Station was far enough away from the frontline to be safe to treat patients* ***(1)****. It was usually a series of large tents or huts* ***(1)****.*
- *Casualty Clearing Stations became important in the treatment of wounds* ***(1)****. Operating theatres were set up to prevent wounded soldiers from developing gangrene* ***(1)****.*

Accept other appropriate features and supporting information.

Question	
1 (b)	Describe **one** feature of developments in the storage of blood on the Western Front. **Target**: knowledge of key features and characteristics of the period. **AO1**: 2 marks.

Marking instructions

Award 1 mark for a valid feature identified. The second mark should be awarded for supporting information.

e.g.

- *A technique was developed to stop stored blood from clotting* ***(1)****. Stored blood could then be used for a blood transfusion without the donor present* ***(1)****.*
- *Scientists discovered blood could be refrigerated* ***(1)****. Refrigerated blood could be kept for a few weeks before use* ***(1)****.*
- *The first blood bank was set up in 1917* ***(1),*** *for the Battle of Cambrai* ***(1)****.*

Accept other appropriate features and supporting information.

Question		
2 (a)		How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the problems of transporting the wounded along the chain of evacuation on the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context. **Target**: Analysis and evaluation of source utility. **AO3**: 8 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• A simple judgement on utility is given, and supported by undeveloped comment on the content of the sources and/or their provenance[1]. Simple comprehension of the source material is shown by the extraction or paraphrase of some content. Limited contextual knowledge is deployed with links to the sources.
2	**3–5**	• Judgements on source utility for the specified enquiry are given, using valid criteria. Judgements are supported by developed comment related to the content of the sources and/or their provenance[1]. Comprehension and some analysis of the sources is shown by the selection and use of material to support comments on their utility. Contextual knowledge is used directly to support comments on the usefulness of the content of the sources and/or their provenance.
3	**6–8**	• Judgements on source utility for the specified enquiry are given, applying valid criteria with developed reasoning which takes into account how the provenance[1] affects the usefulness of the source content. The sources are analysed to support reasoning about their utility. Contextual knowledge is used in the process of interpreting the sources and applying criteria for judgements on their utility.

Notes

1. Provenance = nature, origin, purpose.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

No credit may be given for contextual knowledge unless it is linked to evaluation of the sources.

No credit may be given for generic comments on provenance which are not used to evaluate source content.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited. The grouping of points below does not imply that this is how candidates are expected to structure their answers.

Source A

The usefulness could be identified in terms of the following points which could be drawn from the source:

- Source A is useful because it shows the problem of the terrain that the stretcher bearers had to work through to rescue injured soldiers.
- Source A is useful because it gives details of how dangerous the work of transporting the wounded soldiers was, for example, the German shelling.
- Source A is useful because it suggests that the wounded soldiers had to wait to be transported along the chain of evacuation due to the lack of stretcher bearers.

The following points could be made about the authorship, nature or purpose of the source and applied to ascribe usefulness to material drawn from it:

- As it is a diary, written at the time, it is likely to be an accurate account of what he encountered as a stretcher bearer.
- The account is from the Battle of the Somme and therefore might not be a typical record of the problems faced across the whole of the Western Front throughout the war.

Knowledge of the historical context should be deployed to support inferences and/or to assess the usefulness of information. Relevant points may include:

- In muddy conditions it often took 6 or 8 stretcher bearers to carry one wounded soldier further down the evacuation chain.
- Many of the battles, including the Battle of the Somme, were fought in wet and muddy conditions.

Source B

The usefulness could be identified in terms of the following points which could be drawn from the source:

- Source B is useful because it suggests that motorised ambulances were not effective in the muddy terrain of the Western Front.
- Source B suggests that the transportation of wounded soldiers took a long time due to the conditions which were encountered during the Battle of the Somme.
- Source B is useful for showing the manpower required to salvage the motorised ambulance when the soldiers could be rescuing the wounded.

The following points could be made about the authorship, nature or purpose of the source and applied to ascribe usefulness to material drawn from it:

- As it is an official war photograph, it may be an example of propaganda, which is supported by its publication by the *Daily Mail*. It could be trying to reassure people about the efforts being made to solve the problems faced when transporting the wounded.
- The photograph shows one place on the Western Front in 1916 and might not give an accurate representation of the effectiveness of motorised ambulances or the different terrains on the Western Front.

Knowledge of the historical context should be deployed to support inferences and/or to assess the usefulness of information. Relevant points may include:

- There were 250 motor ambulances in France by November 1914, which were able to carry more wounded soldiers than horse-drawn ambulances.
- Horse-drawn wagons continued to be used throughout the war to transport the wounded as motorised ambulances were not always reliable.

Question	
2 (b)	How could you follow up Source A to find out more about the problems of transporting the wounded along the chain of evacuation on the Western Front? In your answer, you must give the question you would ask and the type of source you could use. **Target**: Source analysis and use (the ability to frame historical questions). **AO3**: 4 marks.

Marking instructions

Award 1 mark for selecting a detail in Source A that could form the basis of a follow-up enquiry and 1 mark for an appropriate follow-up question.

e.g.

- *Detail in Source A that I would follow up: 'The land over which we carried the wounded is very difficult to cross, as it has many waterlogged shell holes.'* ***(1)***
- *Question I would ask: Was it typical for stretcher bearers to have to carry the wounded through difficult terrain across the Western Front?* ***(1)***

(No mark for a question that is **not** linked to following up Source A, e.g. '*because it would be an interesting question to ask*'.)

Award 1 mark for identification of an appropriate source to use in a follow-up enquiry and 1 mark for an answer that explains how the information it contains could help answer the chosen follow-up question.

e.g.

- *What type of source I could use: letters from other stretcher bearers from across the Western Front.* ***(1)***
- *How this might help answer my question: It is likely the letters will describe the conditions on the Western Front, so it will be possible to see if it was typical for stretcher bearers to have to navigate difficult terrain along the chain of evacuation.* ***(1)***

Accept other appropriate alternatives.

Commented [VM1]: Comma before so

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Medicine in Britain, c1250–present

Question		
3		Explain **one** way in which the prevention of infectious diseases in the Renaissance period (c1500–c1700) was **different** from the prevention of infectious diseases in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries (c1700–c1900). **Target**: Analysis of second order concepts: difference [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics of the period [AO1]. **AO2:** 2 marks. **AO1:** 2 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• Simple or generalised comment is offered about a difference [AO2] • Generalised information about the topic is included, showing limited knowledge and understanding of the periods. [AO1]
2	**3–4**	• Features of the period are analysed to explain a difference [AO2] • Specific information about the topic is added to support the comparison, showing good knowledge and understanding of the periods. [AO1]

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

Relevant points may include:

- One way the prevention of infectious diseases was different was due to different ideas about the cause of illness. In the Renaissance, people were unsure about the cause of diseases and relied on preventions, such as purifying the air by burning tar. During the nineteenth century, there was more acceptance of scientific ideas about the causes and people prevented illness through receiving vaccinations, e.g. smallpox vaccination.
- One way in which the prevention of infectious diseases was different was due to a change in the role of the government. During the Renaissance, there was an emphasis on people individually avoiding illness, e.g. coins soaked in vinegar to avoid passing on the plague. However, in the nineteenth century, the role of the government in preventing illness became more important, e.g. the 1875 Second Public Health Act, which made it compulsory for city authorities to provide clean running water to prevent diseases such as cholera.

Question		
4		Explain why hospital care and treatment improved in the period c1700–c1900. You **may** use the following in your answer: • the Nightingale School for Nurses • antiseptics You **must** also use information of your own. **Target**: Analysis of second order concepts: causation/change [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2**: 6 marks. **AO1**: 6 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–3**	• A simple or generalised answer is given, lacking development and organisation. [AO2] • Limited knowledge and understanding of the topic is shown. [AO1]
2	**4–6**	• An explanation is given, showing limited analysis and with implicit or unsustained links to the conceptual focus of the question. It shows some development and organisation of material, but a line of reasoning is not sustained. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing some knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]
3	**7–9**	• An explanation is given, showing some analysis, which is mainly directed at the conceptual focus of the question. It shows a line of reasoning that is generally sustained, although some passages may lack coherence and organisation. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *Maximum 8 marks for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*
4	**10–12**	• An analytical explanation is given which is directed consistently at the conceptual focus of the question, showing a line of reasoning that is coherent, sustained and logically structured. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is precisely selected to address the question directly, showing wide-ranging knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *No access to Level 4 for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

The middle mark in each level may be achieved by stronger performance in either AO1 or AO2.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

Relevant points may include:

- The professionalisation of nurses, through training at establishments such as the Nightingale School for Nurses, meant nurses' practical skills grew more rapidly and fewer patients died of infection as a result.
- New discoveries, such as Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory and antiseptics, meant surgery was more successful and people were more likely to attend a hospital for treatment.
- Joseph Lister's discovery of antiseptics led to further improvements in prevention of infection, e.g. development of the steam steriliser and aseptic surgery.
- Florence Nightingale promoted pavilion-style hospitals that were more ventilated and with isolation wards that stopped disease from spreading.
- New discoveries, such as the development of anaesthetics in surgery, meant treatments that could be received at a hospital became more advanced.
- Hospitals became places of treatment in the eighteenth century, as opposed to places of rest and prayer. Some doctors offered their services free of change to practise their skills in hospitals.

Question		
5		'In the medieval period (c1250–c1500), ideas about the cause of illness were mainly based on religion.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. You **may** use the following in your answer: • the Church • miasma You **must** also use information of your own. **Target**: Analysis and evaluation of second order concepts: significance [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2**: 10 marks. **AO1**: 6 marks. **Spelling, punctuation, grammar and the use of specialist terminology (SPaG)**: up to 4 additional marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–4**	• A simple or generalised answer is given, lacking development and organisation. [AO2] • Limited knowledge and understanding of the topic is shown. [AO1] • The overall judgement is missing or asserted. [AO2]
2	**5–8**	• An explanation is given showing limited analysis and with implicit or unsustained links to the conceptual focus of the question. It shows some development and organisation of material, but a line of reasoning is not sustained. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing some knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1] • The overall judgement is given but its justification is asserted or insecure. [AO2]
3	**9–12**	• An explanation is given, showing some analysis, which is mainly directed at the conceptual focus of the question. It shows a line of reasoning that is generally sustained, although some passages may lack coherence and organisation. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] • The overall judgement is given with some justification, but some criteria selected for the required judgement are left implicit or not validly applied. [AO2] *Maximum 11 marks for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*
4	**13–16**	• An analytical explanation is given which is directed consistently at the conceptual focus of the question, showing a line of reasoning that is coherent, sustained and logically structured. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is precisely selected to address the question directly, showing wide-ranging knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] • Criteria for the required judgement are justified and applied in the process of reaching the overall judgement. [AO2] *No access to Level 4 for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*

Marks for SPaG		
Performance	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	• The learner writes nothing. • The learner's response does not relate to the question. • The learner's achievement in SPaG does not reach the threshold performance level, e.g. errors in spelling, punctuation and grammar severely hinder meaning.
Threshold	**1**	• Learners spell and punctuate with reasonable accuracy. • Learners use rules of grammar with some control of meaning and any errors do not significantly hinder meaning overall. • Learners use a limited range of specialist terms as appropriate.
Intermediate	**2–3**	• Learners spell and punctuate with considerable accuracy. • Learners use rules of grammar with general control of meaning overall. • Learners use a good range of specialist terms as appropriate.
High	**4**	• Learners spell and punctuate with consistent accuracy. • Learners use rules of grammar with effective control of meaning overall. • Learners use a wide range of specialist terms as appropriate.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

The first two bullet points *[AO1 and AO2]* account for 3 of the 4 marks in the level and are equally weighted; the third bullet point *[AO2]* accounts for the remaining mark. Once the level has been found, there are two steps to follow to determine the mark within the level:

- Markers should consider bullet points 1 and 2 together. Strong performance (for the level) in both would be awarded all 3 marks, while 2 marks may be achieved by stronger performance in either bullet point; weak performance would be awarded 1 mark.
- The fourth mark in each level is allocated to the bullet point 3 and should be considered independently of the award of the other marks.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited. The grouping of points below does not imply that this is how candidates are expected to structure their answers.

Relevant points that support the statement may include:

- The Church explained the cause of illness in religious terms, believing that illnesses, such as leprosy, were sent as punishment from God.
- The Church ran medieval hospitals, which prompted the idea that God caused illness, e.g. monks and nuns pointed beds towards a religious object, such as an altar, so patients could pray to God for a cure.
- The Church promoted a rational explanation for illness, the Theory of the Four Humours. The Theory was linked to Galen's belief that the body was designed by God.
- The majority of people in England followed religious teachings on the cause of illness as there was a lack of scientific knowledge.

Relevant points to counter the statement may include:

- Miasma, bad air, was a commonly believed rational explanation for the cause of illness. This led to jobs such as rakers who removed animal dung from the street.

Commented [BD3]: Semi colon should be a comma

Commented [MW4R3]: Changed

- The Theory of the Four Humours was a rational explanation for the cause of illness, which stated that if the four humours of the body became unbalanced a person would be unwell.
- A supernatural explanation of the cause of illness was linked to the movement of the stars and planets. Many people believed that the Black Death was caused by an unusual alignment of the planets.

Question		
6		'Improvements in science and technology is the main reason why there has been progress in medicine in the modern period (c1900-present).' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. You **may** use the following in your answer: • high-tech surgery • the NHS You **must** also use information of your own. **Target**: Analysis and evaluation of second order concepts: causation [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2**: 10 marks. **AO1**: 6 marks. **Spelling, punctuation, grammar and the use of specialist terminology (SPaG)**: up to 4 additional marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–4**	• A simple or generalised answer is given, lacking development and organisation. [AO2] • Limited knowledge and understanding of the topic is shown. [AO1] • The overall judgement is missing or asserted. [AO2]
2	**5–8**	• An explanation is given showing limited analysis and with implicit or unsustained links to the conceptual focus of the question. It shows some development and organisation of material, but a line of reasoning is not sustained. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing some knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1] • The overall judgement is given but its justification is asserted or insecure. [AO2]
3	**9–12**	• An explanation is given, showing some analysis, which is mainly directed at the conceptual focus of the question. It shows a line of reasoning that is generally sustained, although some passages may lack coherence and organisation. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] • The overall judgement is given with some justification, but some criteria selected for the required judgement are left implicit or not validly applied. [AO2] *Maximum 11 marks for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*
4	**13–16**	• An analytical explanation is given which is directed consistently at the conceptual focus of the question, showing a line of reasoning that is coherent, sustained and logically structured. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is precisely selected to address the question directly, showing wide-ranging knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] • Criteria for the required judgement are justified and applied in the process of reaching the overall judgement. [AO2] *No access to Level 4 for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*

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Relevant points that support the statement may include:

- High-tech surgery played an important role in improving the treatments available such as complex lifesaving transplant surgery, and keyhole surgery, which reduced the risk of infection.
- The developments in science allowed for chemical compounds to be mixed as successful treatments, such as magic bullet (Salvarsan 606), which was developed as a cure for syphilis.
- Technology helped to make scientific breakthroughs, e.g. the electron microscope was essential in the discov of the structure of DNA, improving the understanding of the cause of illness.
- Technology played an important role in diagnosing illness, e.g. x-rays and scans, which allowed for more precis and effective treatments.

Relevant points to counter the statement may include:

- The government-funded NHS provided access to specialist hospitals, GPs and universal treatment free at the point of delivery.

Commented [BD5]: Reducing the risk of infection only applies to keyhole surgery so this needs a comma th separate it from transplant surgery - ...transplant surgery, and keyhole surgery, which ...

Commented [MW6R5]: I can see this has been added

Commented [MW7R5]: Sorry, I though I saw a comma. I have now added a comma after surgery

Commented [VM8]: Comma before such

Commented [MW9R8]: added

- The government, through the NHS, and charities, provided funding for the development of new treatments, e.g. immunotherapy as a treatment for lung cancer.
- The work of key individuals such as Fleming, Florey and Chain led to the discovery and development of treatments such as penicillin.
- Research teams and government funding played a role in improving the understanding of the cause of illness through the Human Genome Project, which identified the exact purpose of each gene in the human body.